



NSW Education Standards Authority

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Centre Number

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Student Number

2024 HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION

Modern History

General Instructions

- Reading time – 5 minutes
- Working time – 3 hours
- Write using black pen
- A Source Booklet is provided with this paper
- Write your Centre Number and Student Number at the top of this page

Total marks:
100

Section I – 25 marks (pages 2–6)

- Attempt Questions 1–3
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section II – 25 marks (pages 9–11)

- Attempt ONE question from Questions 4–11
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section III – 25 marks (pages 12–13)

- Attempt ONE question from Questions 12–17
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section IV – 25 marks (pages 14–19)

- Attempt ONE question from Questions 18–23
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

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This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal dotted lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page, providing a guide for handwriting practice. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.

Do NOT write in this area.

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Section I extra writing space

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Section I extra writing space

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Modern History

Section II — National Studies

25 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 4–11

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on pages 2–8 of the Sections II, III and IV Writing Booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate historical knowledge and understanding relevant to the question
 - use relevant evidence and interpretation to support your response
 - communicate ideas and information using historical terms and concepts appropriately
 - present a sustained, logical and cohesive response
-

Question 4 — Option A: Australia 1918–1949 (25 marks)

- (a) Evaluate the extent of exclusion experienced by Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples in Australia during the 1920s. **25**

OR

- (b) Evaluate why Australia's foreign policy changed between 1918 and 1949. **25**

Question 5 — Option B: China 1927–1949 (25 marks)

- (a) Evaluate the strategies used by China to resist the Japanese invasions from 1931. **25**

OR

- (b) Evaluate why the Chinese Communist Party was victorious by 1949. **25**

Question 6 — Option C: India 1942–1984 (25 marks)

- (a) Evaluate the impact of the Emergency (1975–1977) on India. **25**

OR

- (b) Evaluate the success of India's foreign policy in achieving its aims between 1947 and 1984. **25**

Question 7 — Option D: Indonesia 1945–2005 (25 marks)

- (a) Evaluate Suharto's role in the 1965 coup. **25**

OR

- (b) Evaluate why Indonesia's relations with Australia changed between 1945 and 2005. **25**

Question 8 — Option E: Japan 1904–1937 (25 marks)

- (a) Evaluate the impact of the Great Depression on Japan in the 1930s. **25**

OR

- (b) Evaluate the success of Japan's foreign policy in achieving its aims to 1937. **25**

Question 9 — Option F: Russia and the Soviet Union 1917–1941 (25 marks)

- (a) Evaluate why a power struggle emerged following Lenin's death. **25**

OR

- (b) Evaluate the success of Soviet foreign policy in achieving its aims between 1928 and 1941. **25**

Question 10 — Option G: USA 1919–1941 (25 marks)

- (a) Evaluate the impact of social tensions on US society between 1919 and 1941. **25**

OR

- (b) Evaluate the impact of domestic pressure in shaping America's foreign policy between 1919 and 1941. **25**

Question 11 — Option H: Iran 1945–1989 (25 marks)

- (a) Evaluate the impact of the White Revolution and social reforms on Iran between 1953 and 1979. **25**

OR

- (b) Evaluate why Western/US–Iranian relations changed between 1953 and 1989. **25**

Section III — Peace and Conflict

25 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 12–17

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on pages 10–16 of the Sections II, III and IV Writing Booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate historical knowledge and understanding relevant to the question
 - use relevant evidence and interpretation to support your response
 - communicate ideas and information using historical terms and concepts appropriately
 - present a sustained, logical and cohesive response
-

Question 12 — Option A: Conflict in Indochina 1954–1979 (25 marks)

(a) Why was there conflict in Vietnam from 1954? **25**

OR

(b) Why did anti-war movements emerge in response to the war in Vietnam? **25**

Question 13 — Option B: Conflict in the Pacific 1937–1951 (25 marks)

(a) Why were there tensions in the Pacific from 1937? **25**

OR

(b) Why did the United States use the A-Bomb? **25**

Question 14 — Option C: Conflict in Europe 1935–1945 (25 marks)

(a) Why did the conflict in Europe escalate from 1935? **25**

OR

(b) Why did Germany's campaign in Russia fail? **25**

Question 15 — Option D: The Cold War 1945–1991 (25 marks)

- (a) Why did conflict emerge between the superpowers from 1945? **25**

OR

- (b) Why was there a shift towards Détente during the Cold War? **25**

Question 16 — Option E: Conflict in the Gulf 1980–2011 (25 marks)

- (a) Why did tension emerge in the Gulf from 1980? **25**

OR

- (b) Why did the United States decide to withdraw from the Gulf in 2011? **25**

Question 17 — Option F: The Arab–Israeli Conflict 1948–1996 (25 marks)

- (a) Why did the Arab–Israeli conflict emerge from 1948? **25**

OR

- (b) Why did Israel launch invasions in Lebanon in both 1978 and 1982? **25**

Section IV — Change in the Modern World

25 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 18–23

Answer ALL parts of the question

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on pages 18–24 of the Sections II, III and IV Writing Booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate historical knowledge and understanding relevant to the question
 - communicate ideas and information logically
 - use historical terms and concepts appropriately
-

Question 18 — Option A: Pro-democracy Movement in Burma 1945–2010

(25 marks)

- (a) Describe the nature of ethnic tensions in Burma between 1945 and 1988. **5**
- (b) Discuss the impact of the civil war on Burma between 1945 and 1988. Make reference to Source *D* in your response. **8**

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Source D: Military presence in civilian areas on the streets outside Rangoon in 1949.

- (c) How successful was the pro-democracy movement in Burma between 1945 and 2010? **12**

Question 19 — Option B: The Cultural Revolution to Tiananmen Square
1966–1989 (25 marks)

- (a) Describe the reasons for Deng Xiaoping's removal from politics during the Cultural Revolution. **5**
- (b) Discuss the impact of the Cultural Revolution on Chinese society between 1966 and 1976. Make reference to Source *E* in your response. **8**



Hulton Archive/Getty Images

Source *E*: Red Guards reading *Mao's Little Red Book* during the Cultural Revolution.

- (c) How successful were Deng Xiaoping's reforms in China? **12**

Question 20 — Option C: Civil Rights in the USA 1945–1968 (25 marks)

- (a) Describe the Ku Klux Klan's opposition to the civil rights movement. 5
- (b) Discuss the efforts of Martin Luther King Jr to achieve change for African Americans between 1955 and 1968. Make reference to Source *F* in your response. 8



Jobs, jobs, jobs. Athena LeTrelle, CC BY-ND

Source *F*: Martin Luther King Jr and other leaders with linked arms at the March on Washington for Jobs and Freedoms, 28 August 1963.

- (c) How successful were methods employed by civil rights movements between 1945 and 1968 in achieving civil rights? 12

Question 21 — Option D: The Changing World Order 1945–2011 (25 marks)

- (a) Describe the social and cultural impacts of the dissolution of the USSR in Russia and Eastern Europe. **5**
- (b) Discuss the emergence, growth and influence of the European Union between 1989 and 2011. Make reference to Source G in your response. **8**



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Source G: Foreign and Finance Ministers of the 12 Member States of the European Communities Treaty of European Union in Maastricht Netherlands, 7 February 1992.

- (c) How successful was the United Nations in maintaining peace and security in the post-Cold War world between 1991 and 2011? **12**

Question 22 — Option E: The Nuclear Age 1945–2011 (25 marks)

- (a) Describe the development of the Manhattan Project. **5**
- (b) Discuss the nature of nuclear testing in the US and the Soviet Union between 1945 and 1989. Make reference to Source *H* in your response. **8**



Galerie Bildorwelt – Hulton Archive via Getty Images

Source *H*: First atmospheric nuclear test on the Nevada site, located less than an hour's drive from Las Vegas, 27 January 1951.

- (c) How successful was nuclear disarmament between 1960 and 2011? **12**

Question 23 — Option F: Apartheid in South Africa 1960–1994 (25 marks)

- (a) Describe the impact of apartheid on urban communities in South Africa. **5**
- (b) Discuss international responses to South African policies between 1960 and 1994. Make reference to Source *I* in your response. **8**



Source I: March in London to protest British arms sales to South Africa, 17 March 1963.

AAM march and rally in central London 17 March 1963. Copyright © Henry Grant Collection/Museum of London

- (c) How successful was resistance to apartheid within South Africa between 1960 and 1994? **12**

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Modern History

Source Booklet

**Sources
A – C**

Source A (page 2)

Source B (page 2)

Source C (page 2)

Source A

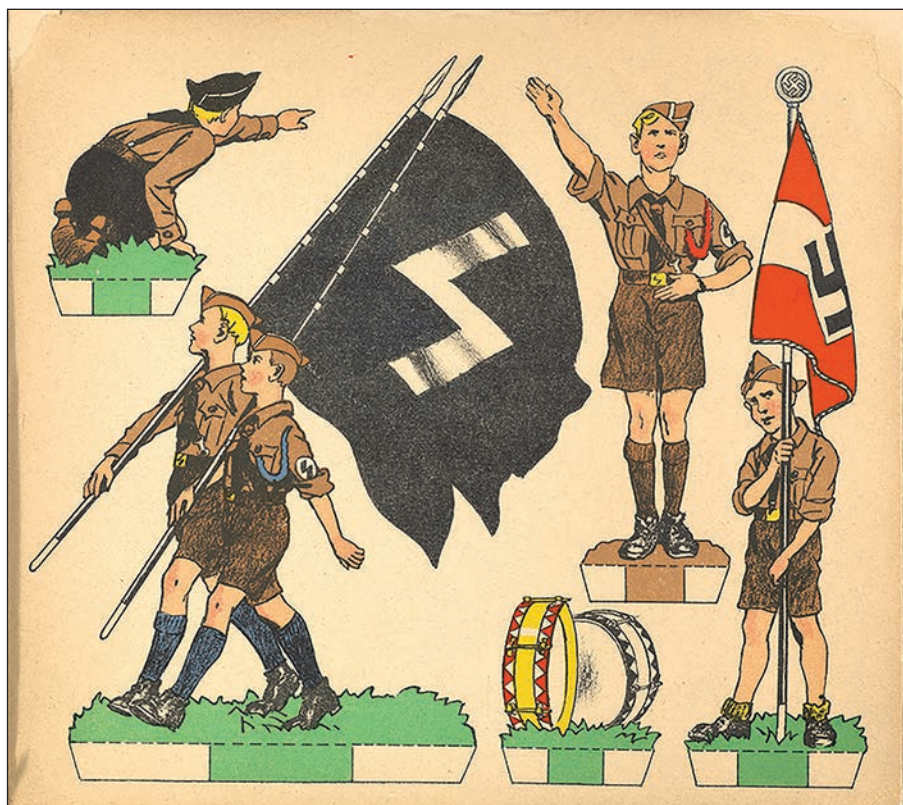
Extract from a speech by Joseph Goebbels at the opening of a women's exhibition in Berlin on 18 March 1933

We do not see the woman as inferior, but rather as having a different mission, a different value, than that of the man. Therefore we believe that the German woman, who more than any other in the world is a woman in the best sense of the word, should use her strength and abilities in other areas than the man ...

At the risk of sounding reactionary and outdated, let me say this clearly: The first, best, and most suitable place for the woman is in the family, and her most glorious duty is to give children to her people and nation, children who can continue the line of generations and who guarantee the immortality of the nation.

Source B

Page from a children's activity book from the 1930s, produced by the Hitler Youth



Wiener Holocaust Library Collections

Source C

Extract from a speech by Robert Ley, leader of the DAF (German Labour Front), 1936

The broad, large and great mass of our people has changed thoroughly. They have been transformed.